

Pricing Approval System Case Study Document -

1. Executive Summary →

This project focuses on transforming a manual pricing approval process into a centralized automated workflow system.

The existing process relied heavily on emails, phone calls, and manual coordination between multiple stakeholders, resulting in delays, errors, lack of visibility, and inefficient reporting.

The proposed solution introduces a structured workflow platform that automates approval routing, enforces business validations, integrates master data, and provides real-time tracking. The system enhances collaboration, improves governance, reduces processing time, and enables scalable digital operations.

2. Business Background

Organizations handling pricing approvals involve multiple stakeholders such as Account Managers (Initiators), Regional Managers, National Sales Heads, Backend SAP Teams, Validators, and Operations Leadership.

Previously, requests were manually created, approvals were completed via email chains, tracking historical decisions was difficult, and reporting required manual effort. On average, 140+ requests were processed daily, creating operational challenges.

3. Problem Statement

Process Challenges:

- Repetitive manual work
- Delayed approvals
- Miscommunication between stakeholders
- Lack of transparency
- Difficulty tracking request lifecycle

Technical Challenges:

- No centralized system
- No audit trail
- High risk of data errors
- Dependency on individual communication

4. Project Objectives

- Create centralized pricing approval platform
- Automate approval workflow routing
- Reduce manual communication dependency
- Improve transparency and reporting
- Implement strict validation rules
- Enable role-based governance
- Provide real-time request tracking

5. Solution Architecture & Approach

The solution introduces a workflow-driven application:

1. Initiator creates pricing request.
2. System validates mandatory fields.
3. Workflow engine routes approvals sequentially.
4. Stakeholders review and take action.
5. Final validation updates master data via SAP integration.

Key design principles include role-based access control, configurable approval rules, master data synchronization, automated notifications, and audit logging.

6. Workflow Design

Approval Flow:

Initiator → Regional Manager → National Sales → Operations Head → Backend SAP Team → Validator

Actions available:

- Approve
- Reject
- Send for Rework (restricted roles)
- Add remarks/comments

7. Key Features Implemented

Request Management:

- Create new request
- Copy existing request

- Save as draft
- Preview before submission

Validation Rules:

- Mandatory field checks
- Customer & Consignee validation
- GSM numeric validation
- Price range validation
- Duplicate request prevention

Data Integration:

- SAP master data integration
- Auto-populated fields
- Payment term logic

8. User Interface & Functional Modules

- Dashboard showing pending approvals
- Expiry alerts for pricing validity
- Graphical reporting
- Saved filters
- File attachments
- Remarks tracking with role visibility

9. Business Impact & Results

- Reduced approval turnaround time
- Improved cross-team visibility
- Eliminated email dependency
- Reduced human errors through validation
- Enabled audit-ready process history
- Faster reporting and analytics

10. Lessons Learned

- Configurable workflow logic is essential for scalability.
- Master data integration reduces manual entry errors.
- Validation rules improve governance.
- Role-based access ensures accountability.

11. Future Enhancements

- AI-driven pricing recommendations
- Predictive approval routing
- Advanced analytics dashboards
- API integrations with external systems

12. Overall Project Conclusion -

The Pricing Approval Workflow Automation project represents a significant digital transformation initiative.

By replacing manual coordination with a structured workflow system, the organization achieved faster processing, improved governance, and higher operational efficiency.

The centralized platform provides transparency, automation, and scalability, laying a strong foundation for future enhancements such as AI-assisted decision-making and advanced data analytics.